



Roll No.

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12thARF(SZ)JKUT2024-25

300-Z

ENGLISH

Time : 3 Hours]

[Maximum Marks : 80

SECTION-A

(READING COMPREHENSION)

1. Read the following passage. Make notes (5 marks) and write a summary (4 marks) and give it a suitable title (1 mark) :

Many of us believe that 'small' means 'insignificant'. We believe that small actions and choices do not have much impact on our lives. We think that it is only the big things, the big actions and the big decisions that really count. But when we look at the lives of all great

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Turn Over

people, you will see that they built their character through small decisions, small choices and small actions they performed everyday.

They transferred their lives through a step-by-step or day-by-day approach. They nurtured and nourished their good habits and chipped away at their bad habits, one step at a time. It was their day-to-day decisions that added up to make tremendous differences in the long run. Indeed, in matters of personal growth and character building, there is no such thing as an overnight success.

Growth always occurs through a sequential series of stages. There is an organic process to growth. When we look at children growing up, we can see this process at work. The child first learns to crawl, then

to stand and walk and finally to run. Same is true in the natural world. The soil must be tilled, seeds sown, providing water and sunlight to it, and only then it will grow into a plant to bear flowers and fruits at the later stages.

Gandhi well understood this organic process and used the universal law of nature to his benefit and to find himself to be the 'Mahatma'.

In fact there was nothing much in his early life, that showed signs of greatness. But from his mid-twenties, onwards he deliberately and consistently attempted to change himself, reformed himself and grew in some small ways everyday.

People have always marvelled at the effortless ways in which Gandhi could accomplish the most difficult task. He displayed great deal of self-mastery, discipline, in facing all struggles, fears, doubtlets and obstacles. We see the victory only but not the struggle by him.

This is a common factor in the lives of all the great people. They exercised their freedoms and choices in small ways that made great impact on their lives and their environments. Each of their small decisions and actions added up to have a profound impact in the long run. So, when our 'ideal goal' looks far from us; We should not be discouraged and disheartened but we need to grow in small steps, small ways to make it easy and thus finally achieved.

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2. Read the following passage and answer the questions given at the end :

Parasites have to pay for their readymade victuals by losing the power of assimilating food in its natural form. In the history of man, the same sin of laziness has always entailed degeneracy. Man becomes parasitical, not only when he fattens on other's toil, but also when he becomes rooted to a particular set of outside conditions and allows himself helplessly to drift along the stream of things as they are; for the outside is alien to the inner self, and if the former be made indispensable by sheer habit, man acquires parasitical characteristics; and becomes unable to perform his true function of converting the impossible to possible.

In this sense, all the lower animals are parasites. They are carried along by their environment; they live or die by natural selection; they progress or retrogress as nature may dictate. Their mind has lost the

power of growth. The bees, for millions of years, have been unable to get beyond the pattern of their hive. For that reason, the form of their cell has attained a certain perfection, but their mentality is confined to the age long habits of their hive-life and cannot roar out of its limitations. Nature has developed cautions, timidity in the case of her lower types of life; She keeps them tied to her apron strings and has stunted their minds, lest they should stray into dangerous experiments.

But providence displayed a sudden accession of creative courage when it comes to man; for his inner nature has not been tied down, though outwardly the poor human creature has been left naked, weak and defenceless. In spite of these disabilities man in the joy of his inward freedom has stood up and declared; I shall achieve the impossible. That is to say, he has consistently refused to submit to the rule of the things, as they always have been, but is determined

to bring about happenings that have never been before. So when in the beginning of the history, man's lot was thrown in with monstrous creatures, tusked and taloned, he did not, like the deer, simply take refuge in flight, nor, like the tortoise take refuge in hiding, but set to work with flints to make even more efficient weapons. It was sheer man's will not to fall a prey to the parasitical web but to rise, fight all odds to achieve the best which often seemed impossible to him. He knew his limitations but he knew his inner strength and power, which ever prompted him to accept and face every challenge and risk to unsolve the mystery and obstacles around his goal, step by step and learning through hit and trial, experience and wit and wisdom. It is why now he explores space and then lands on moon and planning to conquer other planets also. So remember, we have to escape from becoming a parasitical being but to rise to achieve and win with our wit and wisdom and hardwork.

Questions :

- (i) When does man acquire a parasitical characteristics ?
- (ii) As per this paragraph, whose cells have attained a certain perfection ?

(A) Man's

(B) Bee's

(C) None of these

(Choose the correct one)

- (i) 'Victuals' means :

(A) Supplies of food

(B) Existing place of parasites

(C) Man's power and strength

(Choose the correct one)

(iv) What quality has helped man to rise to the high level of life in comparison to other animals ?

(v) What advice does the narrator give to escape being a parasitical being ?

(vi) What is synonym of 'Retrogress' ?

(vii) The lower animals are parasites because they are carried along by their environment and live or die by natural selection.

(True/False)

(viii) Which word in Para (1) mean; 'Urgently necessary' ?

(ix) Give the antonym of 'degeneracy'.

~~(x)~~ Give an appropriate title to this passage.

1×10=10

SECTION-B

(WRITING SKILLS AND GRAMMAR)

β. As the Principal of a public school, you need the services of a computer teacher on ad hoc basis for teaching the students of class 11th and 12th. Write an advertisement for the same to be published in a local Newspaper. (40-50 words)

Or

Your family is celebrating the success of your elder brother in securing M.B.B.S. seat in a Medical College. Invite your close friends on the occasion at a hotel. (40-50 words)

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4. Traffic Jamming has created havoc on the city roads. Write a letter to the Traffic Commissioner about this menace and request to take urgent measures to relieve the people of this problem.

(120–150 words)

Or

Write a letter to the Editor of a local newspaper describing the problems being faced by the students, preparing for the examinations, due to abrupt and unscheduled and long power cuts in the locality.

(120–150 words) 6

5. J & K SSRB has advertised the posts of Lecturer in English and Computer Science. Write a resume (4 marks) with a covering letter/ application (2 marks) for one of the said posts. (120–150 words) 6

6. As an editor of the school magazine, write an article on "Too much consumption of 'junk food' by the students." Mention its harmful effects, both physical and mental. (200–250 words)

Or

Write a speech to be delivered in the morning assembly on 'Role of Youth in Modern India'. (200–250 words)

7. Edit the following passage :

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Somebody knocked on his door. As, soon as I opened the door, I see my friend standing there. I was delighted and welcomed him inside. He has come to invite me on the marriage of his sister next week. It was to took place in a near by banquet hall. I accepted the invitation and thanks him for the same. My mother served us with tea and sum snacks. He left soon as he had to visited some other people to the same purpose.

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8. (a) Read the following poetic extract and answer the questions given at the end :

When Aunt is dead, her terrified hands will lie

Still ringed with ordeals she was mastered by.

The tigers in the panel that she made

Will go on prancing, proud and unafraid.

Questions :

(i) Who is the aunt afraid of ?

(ii) What do the tigers represent here ?

(iii) How has Mrs. Jennifer failed in her aim ?

(iv) Name the poetic device used in the second line.

1×4=4

(b) Answer the following questions (any *two*) from the poems in your text-book (40–50 words each) :

(i) Why does the poet feel her old familiar ache and what is her childhood fear ? (My Mother at Sixty Six)

(ii) What symbols from nature does the poet invoke to say that there can be life under apparent stillness ?

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(Keeping Quiet)

(iii) What is the 'childish longing' that the poet refers to ? Why is it 'Vain' ? (A Roadside Stand)

3×2=6

9. Answer any *three* questions of the following in 40–50 words each :

(i) The people in the story 'The Last Lesson' suddenly realise how precious their language is to them. Why does this happen ?

What does it show ?

(i) Is Saheb happy working at the tea-stall ? Explain.

(Lost Spring)

(ii) How did Douglas overcome his fear of water ? (Deep Water)

(iv) Did the peddler respect the confidence reposed on him by the crofter ? Explain. (The Rat Trap)

(v) Why do you think Gandhi considered the Champaran episode to be turning point in his life ? (Indigo)
3×3=9

10. Answer any *one* of the following questions in 150–200 words :

(i) The story is a satire on the conceit of those in power. How does the author employ the literary device of dramatic irony in the story. (The Tiger King)

(ii) Why did Dr. Sadao feel compelled to help the wounded enemy soldier ? What made his wife sympathetic to him in the face of open defiance from the domestic staff ? (The Enemy) 6

II. Answer any one of the following questions in 120-150 words :

(i) Mr Lamb and Derry are two highly contrasting characters.

Highlight the contrasting traits in their characters.

(ii) How did Mr. Lamb's meeting with Derry became a turning point in Derry's life ?

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